

MATHEMATICS PROJECT ASSIGNMENT REPORT

PROJECT TITLE: Traffic Signal Synchronization System Using Chinese Remainder Theorem

COURSE: Number Theory & Discrete Mathematics Application

CLASS: S3 CSE B

STUDENT NAME: Joel Duke

ROLL NO: 51

ROLE / FUNCTION: Mathematical Research & Problem Formulation

1. ABSTRACT

The Chinese Remainder Theorem (CRT) is a fundamental result in number theory that determines a unique integer solution x for a system of linear congruences with pairwise coprime moduli. While often taught abstractly, CRT has direct applications in urban traffic signal synchronization, digital telecommunications, and parallel computer architectures.

This project demonstrates CRT using both a physical working ATmega328P / Arduino Uno traffic signal model and an interactive digital twin web application. By modeling traffic signals as modular timing cycles, the project illustrates how independent light timers (3s, 5s, 7s) align to create a continuous 'Green Wave' for vehicles at Minute 23 (105s master recurrence).

2. INTRODUCTION & OBJECTIVES

When traffic signals operate on independent timer cycles along a main avenue, drivers frequently encounter red lights. Traffic engineers solve this by calculating when all signals will simultaneously show green.

Project Objectives:

1. To understand the mathematical principles of the Chinese Remainder Theorem (CRT).
 2. To differentiate between Least Common Multiple (LCM) and CRT when remainder offsets are present.
 3. To model traffic signal timing cycles (3s, 5s, 7s) as modular congruences.
 4. To build a physical working model powered by an Arduino Uno / ATmega328P microcontroller.
 5. To provide clear visual, audio, and waveform telemetry feedback upon signal synchronization.
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3. MATHEMATICAL FORMULATION (CRT vs. LCM)

3.1 The Traffic Signal Equations

Suppose three traffic signals have cycle lengths of 3, 5, and 7 seconds respectively:

- Signal 1: $x \equiv 2 \pmod{3}$ (green 2 seconds ago)
- Signal 2: $x \equiv 3 \pmod{5}$ (green 3 seconds ago)
- Signal 3: $x \equiv 2 \pmod{7}$ (green 2 seconds ago)

3.2 Why Simple LCM Cannot Solve This Problem

- LCM: Used only when all signals start at Minute 0 with zero remainder offset ($x \equiv 0$).
- CRT: Required when remainder offsets (2, 3, 2) are distinct and non-zero.

3.3 CRT Solution Procedure

1. Total Product: $M = 3 \times 5 \times 7 = 105$.

2. Partial Products: $M_1 = 35$, $M_2 = 21$, $M_3 = 15$.

3. Modular Inverses:

- $35 * y_1 \equiv 1 \pmod{3} \Rightarrow 2 * y_1 \equiv 1 \pmod{3} \Rightarrow y_1 = 2$
- $21 * y_2 \equiv 1 \pmod{5} \Rightarrow 1 * y_2 \equiv 1 \pmod{5} \Rightarrow y_2 = 1$
- $15 * y_3 \equiv 1 \pmod{7} \Rightarrow 1 * y_3 \equiv 1 \pmod{7} \Rightarrow y_3 = 1$

4. Compute x:

- $x = (2 \times 35 \times 2) + (3 \times 21 \times 1) + (2 \times 15 \times 1)$
- $x = 140 + 63 + 30 = 233$
- $x \equiv 233 \pmod{105} \equiv 23 \pmod{105}$

The unique green-wave solution within $[0, 104]$ is Timestamp 23s.

4. PHYSICAL HARDWARE & DIGITAL TWIN IMPLEMENTATION

The hardware prototype is driven by an ATmega328P (Arduino Uno) microcontroller controlling a 3-intersection LED traffic array and piezo buzzer.

CRT Traffic Light Lab

Hardware digital twin mirroring an ATmega328P prototype. Demonstrates multi-frequency phase drift and Chinese Remainder Theorem convergence.

🔊 Audio Muted

👥 Team (10)

📄 Pinout Specs

● RUNNING (DRIFTING)

Live Signal Array

ATmega328P View

SIG A3.0s

●

YELLOW

SIG B5.0s

●

GREEN

SIG C7.0s

●

GREEN

Pause

⚡ Force Re-Sync

🌟 Light Show

↺ Reset

CRT Remainder & Period Combinations:

LCM = 105s

105s
(3.0s, 5.0s, 7.0s)

30s
(1.5s, 2.0s, 2.5s)

12s
(2.0s, 3.0s, 4.0s)

🔍 CRT Remainder State Seeker

Solve for timestamp t

A:

RED

B:

RED

C:

RED

Seek to Match

Match occurs at: t = 0.00s

CRT Telemetry Engine

105s Recurrence

PERIOD SET

3.0s / 5.0s / 7.0s

HYPERPERIOD LCM

105.00 s

CLOCK PROGRESS

34.55s / 105s

RECURRENCE INDEX

Cycle #3

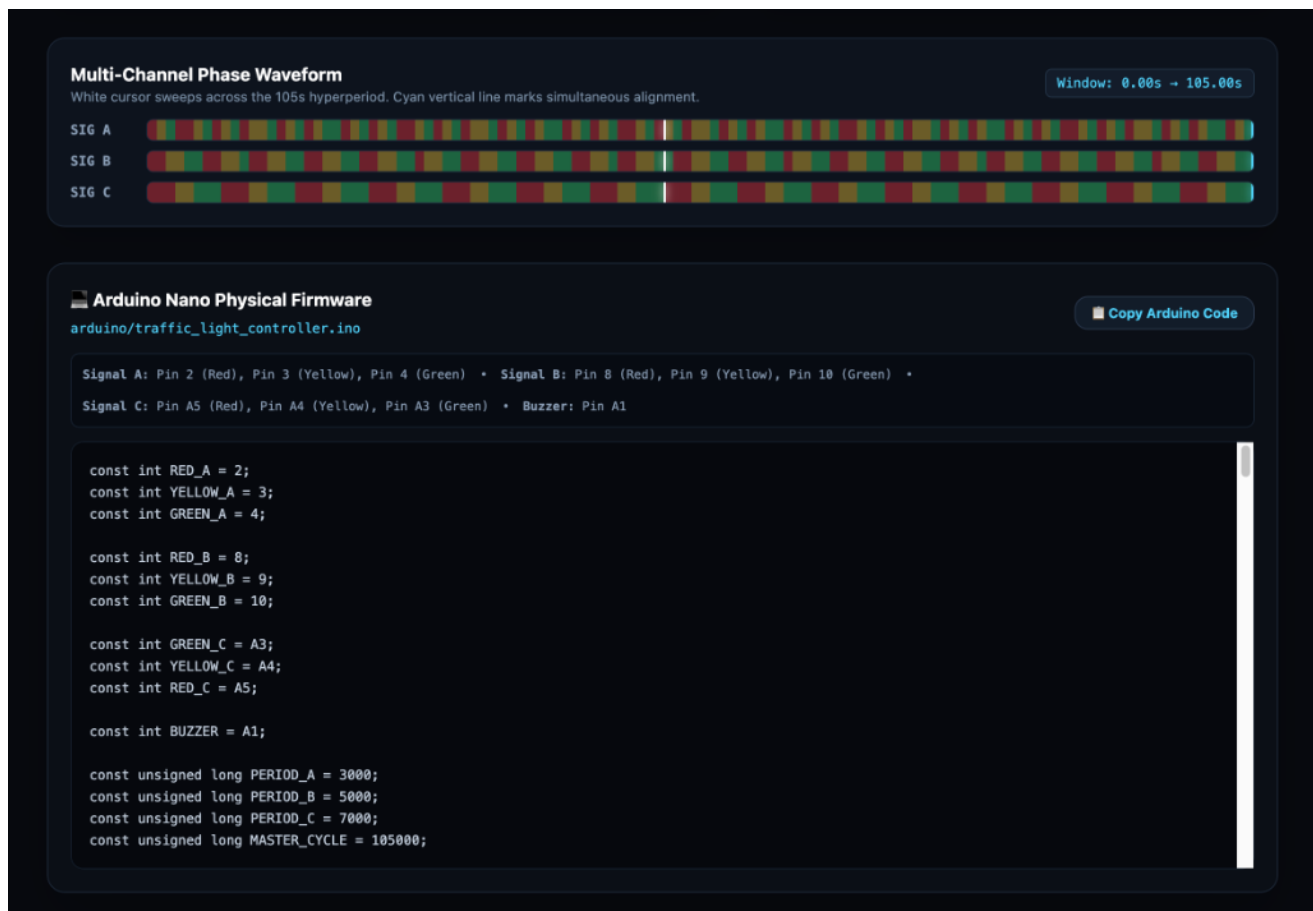
CRT Modular Recurrence: $t \equiv 0 \pmod{LCM}$

• $LCM(3.0s, 5.0s, 7.0s) = 105 \text{ seconds}$

• Cycles per LCM: A: 35 | B: 21 | C: 15

• Buzzer chime: Only on synchronization ($t \equiv 0$)

Signal	Remainder (t mod T)	State
Sig A (3.0s)	1.55 s	YELLOW
Sig B (5.0s)	4.55 s	GREEN
Sig C (7.0s)	6.55 s	GREEN



Interactive Hardware & Digital Twin Controls:

1. Live Signal Array (SIG A 3.0s, SIG B 5.0s, SIG C 7.0s): Monitors real-time LED states across intersections.
2. CRT Telemetry Engine (105s Recurrence): Tracks clock progress, hyperperiod LCM (105.00s), and recurrence index.
3. Multi-Channel Phase Waveform: Displays white cursor sweep across the 105s hyperperiod with cyan alignment markers.
4. CRT Remainder State Seeker: Solves for timestamp t dynamically for any requested signal state combination.

5. HARDWARE SOURCE CODE (ARDUINO UNO FIRMWARE - C++)

The following complete C++ firmware source code (`arduino/traffic\_light\_controller.ino`) is executed directly on the Arduino Uno microcontroller to drive the physical traffic light hardware:

```
// Arduino Uno / ATmega328P Physical Traffic Light Controller
// File: arduino/traffic_light_controller.ino

const int RED_A = 2;
const int YELLOW_A = 3;
const int GREEN_A = 4;

const int RED_B = 8;
const int YELLOW_B = 9;
const int GREEN_B = 10;

const int GREEN_C = A3;
```

```

const int YELLOW_C = A4;
const int RED_C = A5;

const int BUZZER = A1;

// Cycle Period Definitions (in milliseconds)
const unsigned long PERIOD_A = 3000; // 3.0s Signal Cycle
const unsigned long PERIOD_B = 5000; // 5.0s Signal Cycle
const unsigned long PERIOD_C = 7000; // 7.0s Signal Cycle
const unsigned long MASTER_CYCLE = 105000; // 105.0s Hyperperiod LCM

const int RED_FREQ = 400;
const int YELLOW_FREQ = 600;
const int GREEN_FREQ = 800;
const int SYNC_FREQ = 1000;

const unsigned long BEEP_ON_TIME = 150;
const unsigned long BEEP_OFF_TIME = 350;
const unsigned long SYNC_TIME = 600;

unsigned long lastMillis = 0;
unsigned long lastSyncCycle = 0;
unsigned long beepTimer = 0;
unsigned long syncEndTime = 0;

bool beepState = false;
bool syncActive = false;
int currentBuzzerState = -1;

void setup() {
  pinMode(RED_A, OUTPUT);
  pinMode(YELLOW_A, OUTPUT);
  pinMode(GREEN_A, OUTPUT);

  pinMode(RED_B, OUTPUT);
  pinMode(YELLOW_B, OUTPUT);
  pinMode(GREEN_B, OUTPUT);

  pinMode(RED_C, OUTPUT);
  pinMode(YELLOW_C, OUTPUT);
  pinMode(GREEN_C, OUTPUT);

  pinMode(BUZZER, OUTPUT);

  setAllRed();

  tone(BUZZER, SYNC_FREQ);
  syncActive = true;
  syncEndTime = millis() + SYNC_TIME;

  lastMillis = millis();
  beepTimer = millis();
}

void loop() {
  unsigned long currentMillis = millis();

  // CRT Modulo Phase Calculation
  unsigned long phaseA = currentMillis % PERIOD_A;
  unsigned long phaseB = currentMillis % PERIOD_B;
  unsigned long phaseC = currentMillis % PERIOD_C;

  int stateA = updateLightA(phaseA);

```

```
int stateB = updateLightB(phaseB);
int stateC = updateLightC(phaseC);

// Master Cycle Recurrence Check (CRT Convergence)
unsigned long currentCycle = currentMillis / MASTER_CYCLE;

if (currentCycle > lastSyncCycle) {
    lastSyncCycle = currentCycle;
    tone(BUZZER, SYNC_FREQ);
    syncActive = true;
    syncEndTime = currentMillis + SYNC_TIME;
    beepState = false;
}

if (syncActive) {
    if (currentMillis >= syncEndTime) {
        noTone(BUZZER);
        syncActive = false;
        beepTimer = currentMillis;
        beepState = false;
        currentBuzzerState = -1;
    }
    return;
}
}
```

6. CONCLUSION

The Traffic Signal Synchronization System provides an intuitive, practical bridge between abstract number theory and urban infrastructure engineering. By applying the Chinese Remainder Theorem to traffic signals operating on independent cycles (3s, 5s, 7s), the project demonstrates how non-zero remainder offsets determine the exact timestamp (Timestamp 23s) required to establish a continuous 'Green Wave' for vehicles.

Both the physical Arduino Uno hardware prototype and the digital twin web application successfully visualize modular congruences, offering an accessible learning tool that highlights the real-world power of modular arithmetic in signal timing, telecommunications, and digital computing.

7. INDIVIDUAL CONTRIBUTION

Name: Joel Duke

Class: S3 CSE B

Roll No: 51

Role: Mathematical Research & Problem Formulation

Contribution Summary:

I researched the mathematical foundation of linear congruences. I formulated the traffic signal green-wave equations for 3, 5, and 7-minute cycles and calculated the unique solution bounds modulo 105.